



ping – that “suggest” apps to download. It’s basically an ad, but compared to phones like the Realme C65, this is definitely the lesser of the evils.

Adding to the relatively clean software is support for nifty Motorola features like Smart Connect and Family Space. Smart Connect is only available on the 8 GB variant, the 4 GB variant gets the older ‘Ready For’ application. Regardless, the option of having this useful feature at a very affordable price is a huge point in its favour.

CAMERAS

The Motorola G45 features a humble 50 MP + 2 MP dual camera setup with one primary camera without OIS and one nominal macro shooter. For selfies, you get a 16 MP shooter. The phone supports 1080p videos at 30 fps on both front and rear cameras.

In daylight, the Motorola G45 outputs aesthetically-appealing photos with saturated colours and good detail. The detail in the shadows, however, misses the mark at times. As for portraits, the phone does a good job for the price, with warm human skin tones and a decent portrait cutout. Close-up photos have a good natural bokeh effect but the detail is a bit soft, especially if

your subject is moving since the phone doesn’t have OIS support.

Selfies look decent in both daylight and low-light but the skin’s textures can get a bit too smoothed out in some scenarios. As for low light photos from the primary camera, there’s quite a bit of noise but that’s expected at this price range.

BATTERY LIFE

The Motorola G45 is equipped with a 5,000 mAh cell with support for 18 W fast charging. However, you get a 20 W TurboPower charger out of the box. Now, the phone doesn’t have class-leading battery life. You get about one full day of usage at medium usage, while some other budget phones go up to the two-day mark.

The phone lasted 13 hours and 42 minutes in the PCMark Battery test, which is decent. I got about 5 hours of screen-on time with heavy usage which included benchmarking, clicking photos, watching shows on OTT platforms, and more. So, overall, the battery life is good, but it’s not close to being the best.

As for charging, with the slow 18 W charging, the phone takes a lengthy 1 hour and 36 minutes to charge from 0 to 100 percent.

VERDICT

The Motorola G45 stands out with a design that feels far more premium than its price suggests, making it one of the best-looking phones not only under ₹15K but also under ₹20K. It offers a clean software experience, smooth performance for everyday tasks, 5G support, and decent cameras for its price range. While it does have some drawbacks, such as low display brightness and slower storage speeds, these issues are minor and unlikely to be deal breakers for potential buyers. Overall, the Motorola G45 is a well-rounded budget phone that provides excellent value for money and poses strong competition in its price segment.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 6s Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 619 | 5G Bands: 13 | RAM: 4/8 GB | Storage: 128 GB, Expandable up to 1 TB | OS: Android 14, Hello UI | Display: 6.5" IPS LCD, HD+ resolution, 120 Hz refresh rate | Display Protection: Corning Gorilla Glass 3 | Cameras: 50 MP + 2 MP | Selfie Camera: 16 MP | Battery Capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 18 W | Colours: Brilliant Blue, Brilliant Green, Viva Magenta | Speakers: Stereo with Dolby Atmos | IP Rating: IP52

CONTACT

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